



Threat Advisory

**Active phishing operation
targeting e-challan users via
browser-based vectors and
shared infrastructure**

9 February 2026



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Executive Summary

Maharashtra Cyber Security Researcher's observed a renewed phishing wave abusing the e-Challan ecosystem to conduct financial fraud. Unlike earlier Android malware- driven campaigns, this activity relies entirely on browser-based phishing, significantly lowering the barrier for victim compromise. During the course of this research, CRIL also noted that similar fake e-Challan scams have been highlighted by mainstream media outlets, including Hindustan Times, underscoring the broader scale and real-world impact of these campaigns on Indian users. The campaign primarily targets Indian vehicle owners via unsolicited SMS messages claiming an overdue traffic fine. The message includes a deceptive URL resembling an official e-Challan domain. Once accessed, victims are presented with a cloned portal that mirrors the branding and structure of the legitimate government service. At the time of this writing, many of the associated phishing domains were active at the time, indicating that this is an ongoing and operational campaign rather than an isolated or short-lived activity.

The same hosting IP was observed serving multiple phishing lures impersonating government services, logistics companies, and financial institutions, indicating a shard phishing backend supporting multi-sector fraud operations. The infection chain, outlined in Figure 1, showcases the stages of the attack.

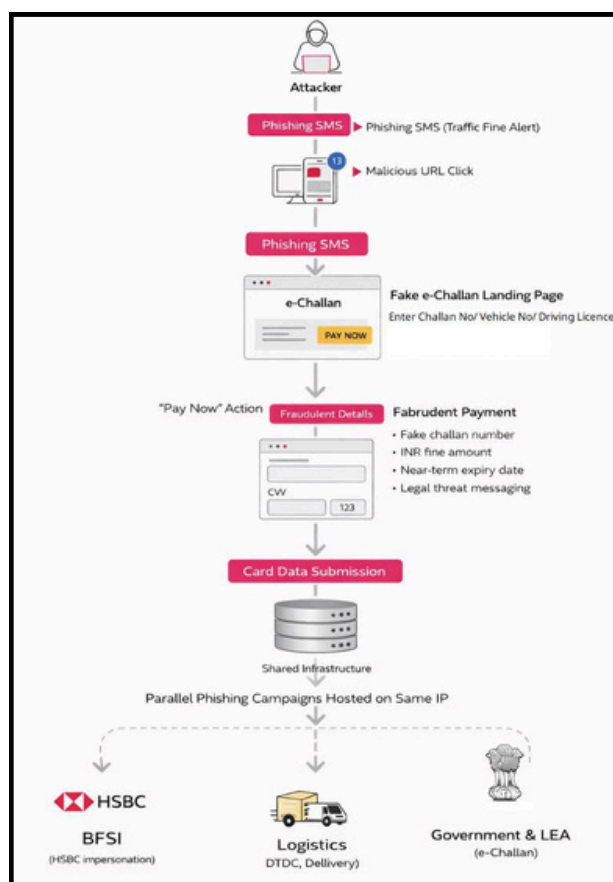


Figure 1- Campaign Overview

Key Takeaways

- Attackers are actively exploiting RTO/e-Challan themes, which remain highly effective against Indian users.
- The phishing portal fabricates challan data dynamically, requiring no prior victim-specific information.
- The payment workflow is deliberately restricted to credit/debit cards, avoiding traceable UPI or net banking rails.
- Infrastructure analysis links this campaign to BFSI and logistics-themed phishing hosted on the same IP.
- Browser-based warnings (e.g., Microsoft Defender) are present but frequently ignored due to urgency cues.

A sense of urgency, evidenced in this campaign, is usually a sign of deception. By demanding a user's immediate attention, the intent is to make a potential victim rush their task and not perform due diligence.

Users must accordingly exercise caution, scrutinize the domain, sender, and never trust any unsolicited link(s).

Risk Score	High
TLP Rating	CLEAR
Threat Actor	NA
Known Aliases	NA
Malware/Campaign	e-challan phishing campaign
Target	Government & LEA, BFSI
Impacted Country/Region	India

Technical Analysis

Stage 1: Phishing SMS Delivery

The attack we first identified started with victims receiving an SMS stating that a traffic violation fine is overdue and must be paid immediately to avoid legal action. The message includes:

- Threatening language (legal steps, supplementary charges) • A shortened or deceptive URL mimicking e-Challan branding
- No personalization, allowing large-scale delivery

The sender appears as a standard mobile number, which increases delivery success and reduces immediate suspicion. (see Figure 2)

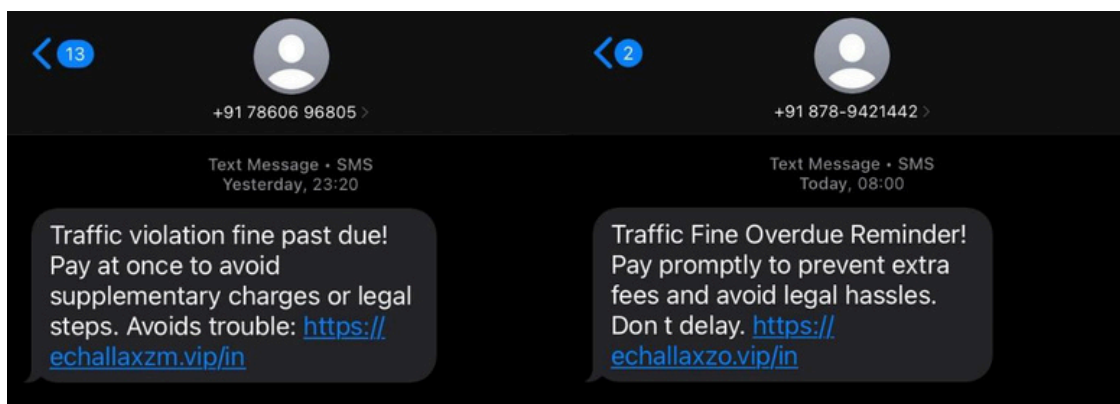


Figure 2 – Fraudulent traffic violation SMS delivering a malicious e-Challan payment link

Stage 2: Redirect to Fraudulent e-Challan Portal

Clicking the embedded URL redirects the user to a phishing domain hosted on 101[.]33[.]78[.]145. The page content is originally authored in Spanish and translated to English via browser prompts, suggesting the reuse of phishing templates across regions. (see Figure 3)

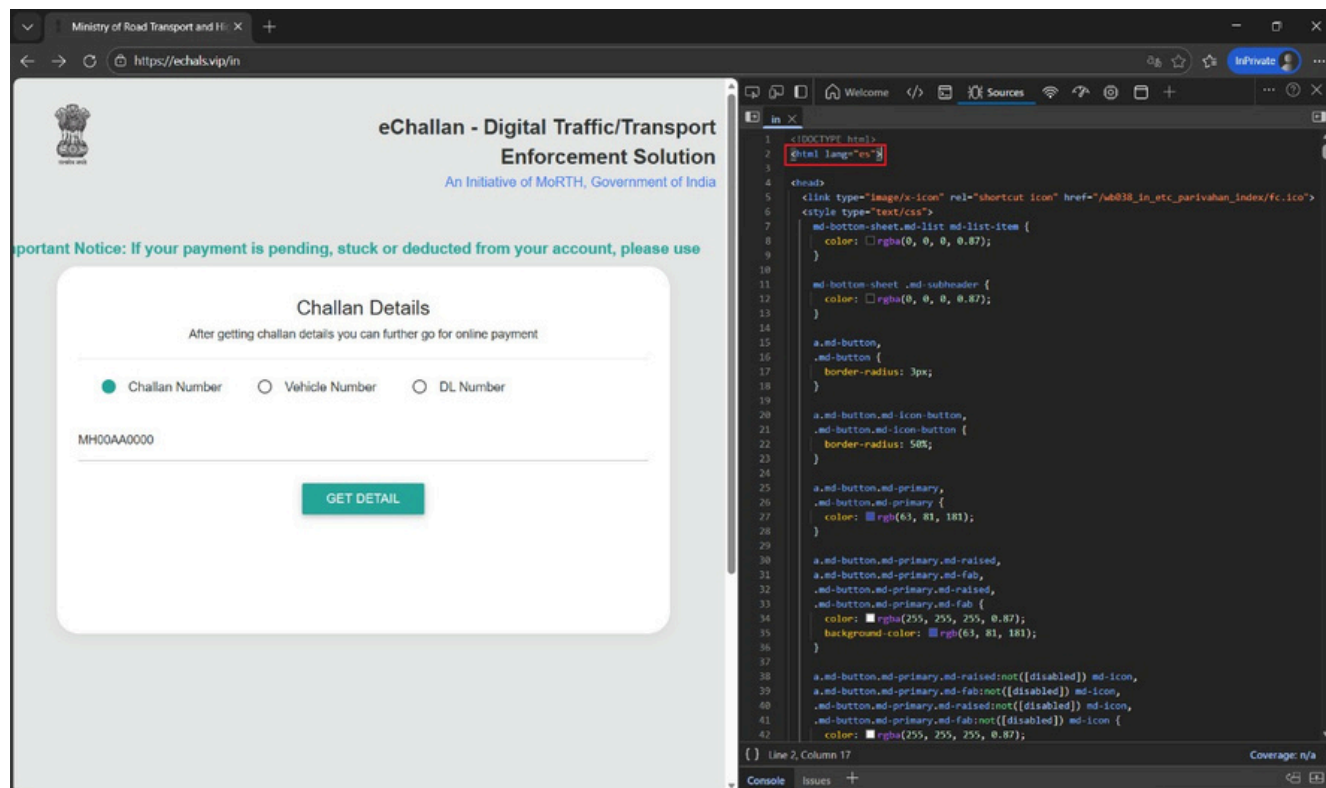


Figure 3: Fake e-Challan landing page

Stage 3: Fabricated Challan Generation

The portal prompts the user to enter:

- Vehicle Number
- Challan Number
- Driving License Number

Regardless of the input provided, the system returns:

- A valid-looking challan record
- A modest fine amount (e.g., INR 590)
- A near-term expiration date
- Prominent warnings about license suspension, court summons, and legal proceedings

This step is purely psychological validation, designed to convince victims that the challan is legitimate. (see Figure 4)

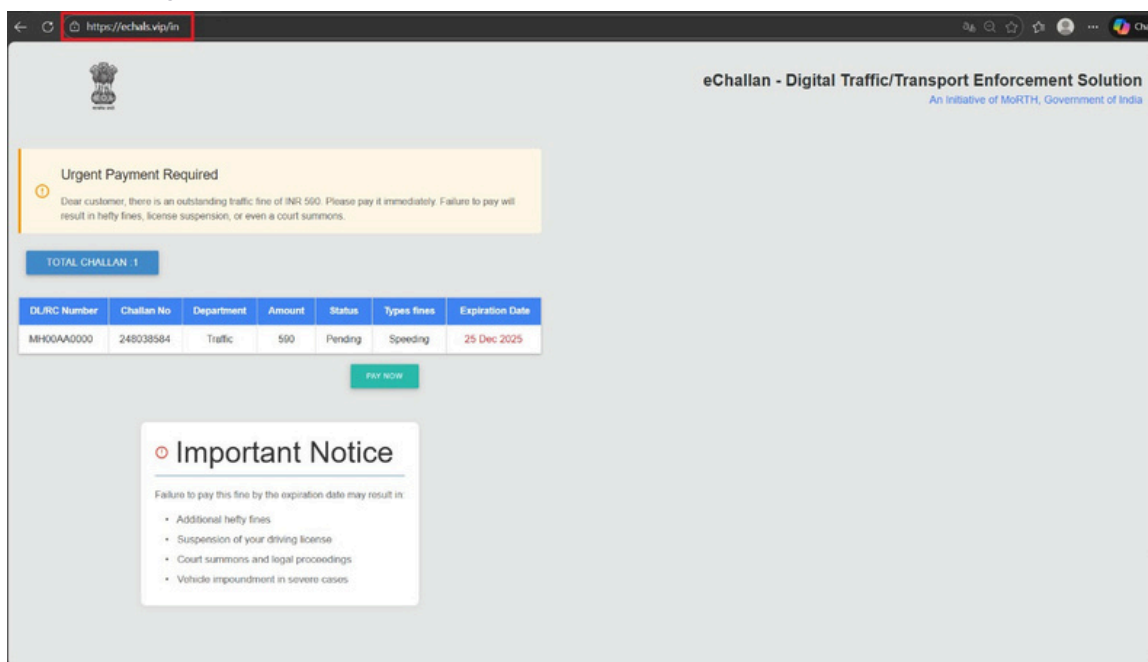


Figure 4: Fraudulent e-Challan record generated

Stage 4: Card Data Harvesting

Upon clicking "Pay Now", victims are redirected to a payment page claiming secure processing via an Indian bank. However:

- Only credit/debit cards are accepted
- No redirection to an official payment gateway occurs
- CVV, expiry date, and cardholder name are collected directly

During testing, the page accepted repeated card submissions, indicating that all entered card data is transmitted to the attacker backend, independent of transaction success. (see Figure 5)

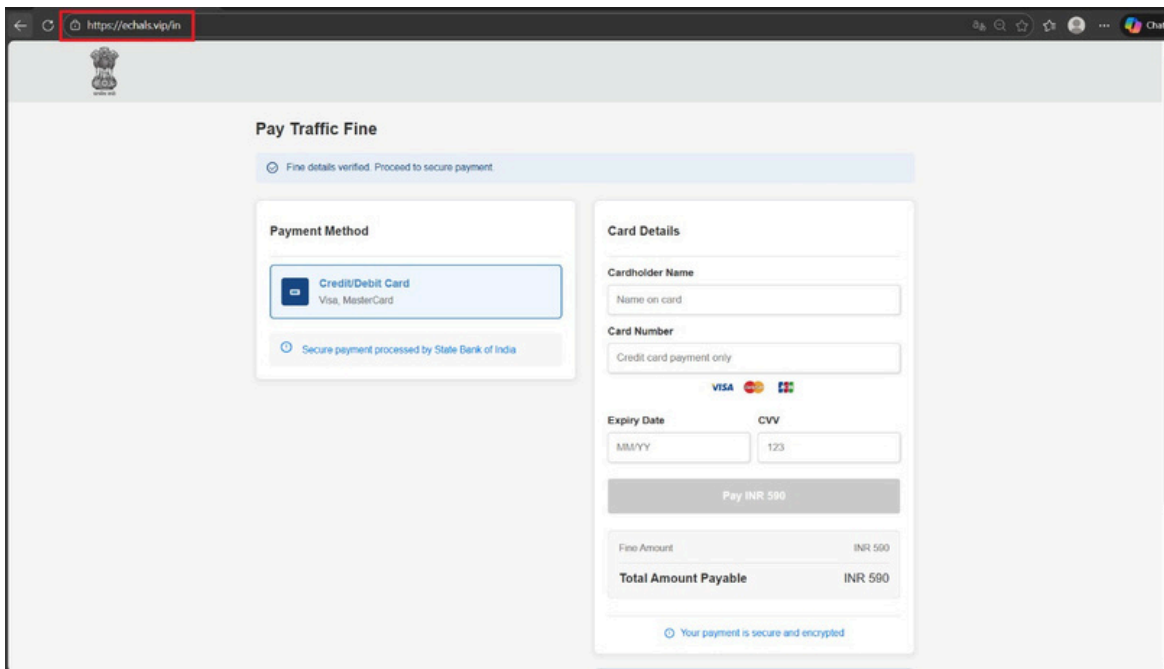


Figure 5: e-Challan payment page restricted to card-only transactions

Infrastructure Correlation and Campaign Expansion

CRIL identified another attacker-controlled IP, 43[.]130[.]12[.]41, hosting multiple domains impersonating India's e-Challan and Parivahan services. Several of these domains follow similar naming patterns and closely resemble legitimate Parivahan branding, including domains designed to look like Parivahan variants (e.g., parizvaihen[.]icu). Analysis indicates that this infrastructure supports rotating, automatically generated phishing domains, suggesting the use of domain generation techniques to evade takedowns and blocklists.

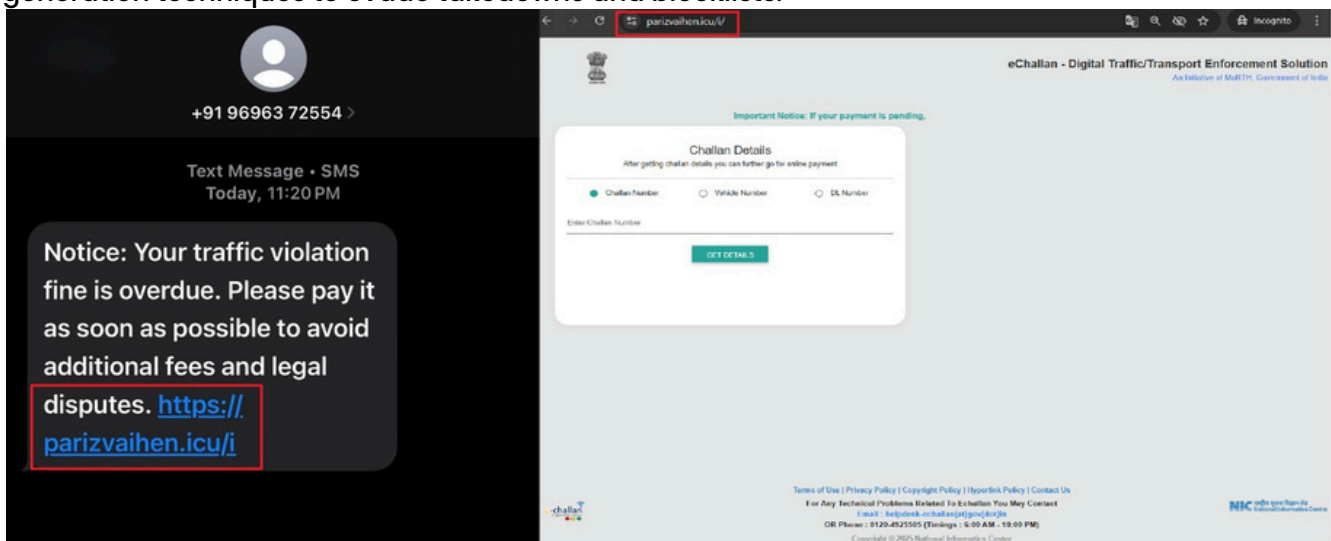


Figure 6: Secondary phishing infrastructure supporting fake e-Challan portals

The phishing pages hosted on this IP replicate the same operational flow observed in the primary campaign, displaying fabricated traffic violations with fixed fine amounts, enforcing urgency through expiration dates, and redirecting victims to fake payment pages that harvest full card details while falsely claiming to be backed by the State Bank of India. This overlap in infrastructure,

page structure and social engineering themes suggests a broader, scalable phishing ecosystem that actively exploits government transport services to target Indian users.

Further investigation into IP address 101[.]33[.]78[.]145 revealed more than 36 phishing domains impersonating e-Challan services, all hosted on the same infrastructure.

The infrastructure also hosted phishing pages targeting:

- BFSI (e.g., HSBC-themed payment lures)
- Logistics companies (DTDC, Delhivery) (see Figure 7,8)

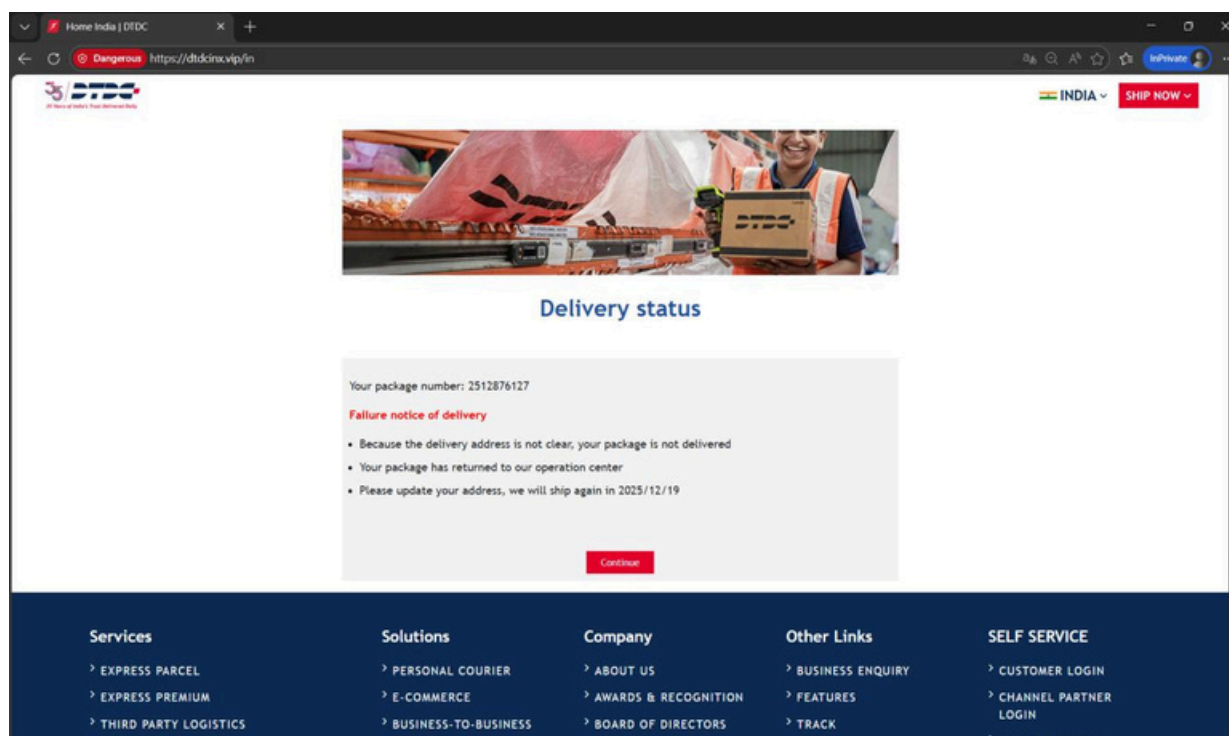


Figure 7: DTDC-themed phishing page impersonating a failed delivery notification

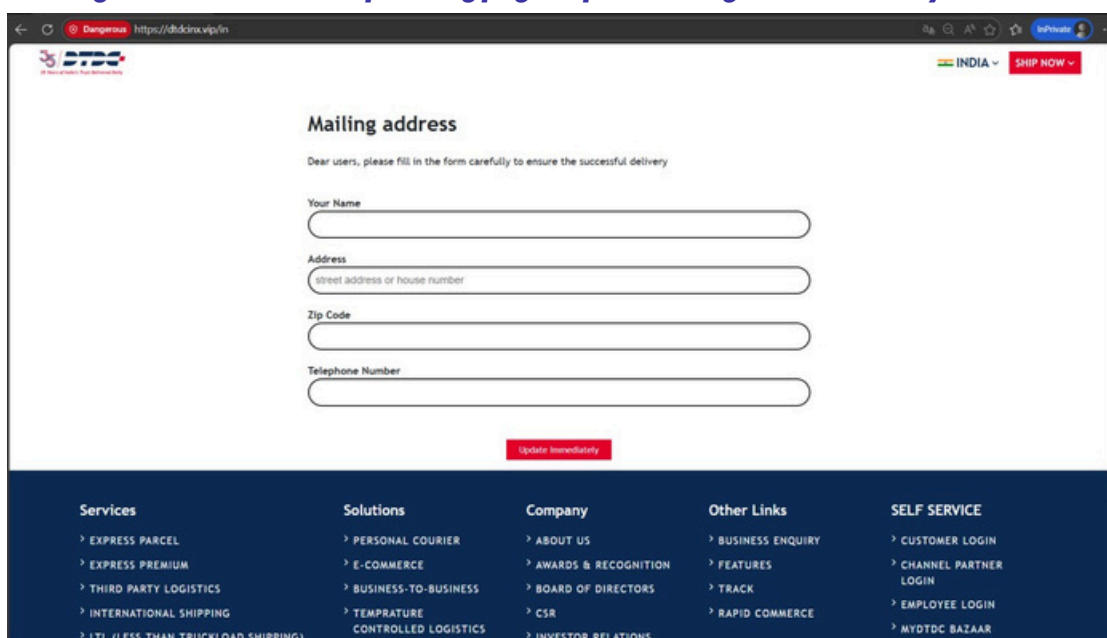


Figure 8: Fake DTDC address update page used for data harvesting

Consistent UI patterns and payment-harvesting logic across campaigns. This confirms the presence of a shared phishing infrastructure supporting multiple fraud verticals.

SMS Origin and Phone Number Analysis

As part of the continued investigation, CRIL analyzed the originating phone number used to deliver the phishing e-Challan SMS. A reverse phone number lookup confirmed that the number is registered in India and operates on the **Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited** mobile network, indicating the use of a locally issued mobile connection rather than an international SMS gateway. Additionally, analysis of the number showed that it is linked to a **State Bank of India (SBI)** account, further reinforcing the campaign's use of localized infrastructure. The combination of an Indian telecom carrier and association with a prominent public-sector bank likely enhances the perceived legitimacy of the scam. It increases the effectiveness of government-themed phishing messages. (see Figure 9)

Reverse Number Lookup Details for 087894 21442

Local Formatted Number Locally formatted number based on the country.	087894 21442
Valid Is this phone number valid?	Valid Number
Owner Name Owner's first & last name or business name.	Please upgrade for enhanced name checks.
Owner Email Email address associated with the phone number.	
Country What country is this phone number located in?	IN
Region What region or state is this phone number located in?	India
Carrier Name Which telecom provider manages this telephone number?	Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited
Line Type View line type status such as VOIP, cellular, landline, satellite, pager, etc.	Wireless
Reverse Email Lookup Email Address associated with the phone number.	Available for upgraded accounts.
Active Line View the subscriber status. Is this phone number currently active or disconnected?	Use our HLR lookup service to view the line's subscriber status.
Abusive Phone Is this phone number associated with SPAM, scams, or fraudulent behavior?	Please create a free account to view reputation data.
Leaked Online Has this phone number been exposed in an online data breach?	Not Leaked
Phone Number Activity Frequency that this number is being used for legitimate purchases, account registrations, & healthy behavior online.	Please create a free account to view user activity scores.

[Create a free account](#) to access more lookup details with greater accuracy.

Paying to

SK

Shubham Kumar Rawani
kumarshivam06894@oksbi

Sending to: State Bank of India

Show payment history

₹0

Add Message

Continue

UPI

Figure9:Phonenumber intelligence linked to the e-Challan phishing campaign

Targeted Industries

Based on infrastructure reuse and observed phishing lures, this campaign targets:

Government & Law Enforcement Agencies (LEA)

- e-Challan, traffic enforcement impersonation Logistics & Supply Chain
- DTDC, Delhivery-themed phishing
- Banking, Financial Services, and Insurance (BFSI)
- HSBC payment and verification lures

Conclusion

This campaign demonstrates that RTO-themed phishing remains a high-impact fraud vector in India, particularly when combined with realistic UI cloning and psychological urgency. The reuse of infrastructure across government, logistics, and BFSI lures highlights a professionalized phishing operation rather than isolated scams.

As attackers continue shifting from malware delivery to direct financial fraud, user awareness alone is insufficient. Infrastructure monitoring, domain takedowns, and proactive SMS phishing detection are critical to disrupting these operations at scale.

Recommendations

- Always verify traffic fines directly via official government portals, not SMS links.
- Organizations should monitor for lookalike domains abusing government and brand identities.
SOC teams should track shared phishing infrastructure, as takedown of one domain may disrupt multiple campaigns.
- Telecom providers should strengthen SMS filtering for financial and government-themed lures.
- Financial institutions should monitor for card-not-present fraud patterns linked to phishing campaigns.

MITRE ATT&CK® Techniques

Tactic	Technique ID	Technique Name
Initial Access	T1566.001	Phishing: Spearphishing via SMS
Credential Access	T1056	Input Capture
Collection	T1119	Automated Collection
Exfiltration	T1041	Exfiltration Over C2 Channel
Impact	T1657	Financial Theft

• Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

The IOCs have been added to this [GitHub repository](#). Please review and integrate them into your Threat Intelligence feed to enhance protection and improve your overall security posture.

Indicators		
echala[.]vip	Domain	Phishing Domain
echallaxzov[.]vip		
echallaxzrx[.]vip		
echallaxzm[.]vip		
echallaxzv[.]vip		
echallaxzx[.]vip		
echallx[.]vip		
echalln[.]vip		
echallv[.]vip		
delhirzexu[.]vip		
delhirzexi[.]vip		
delhizery[.]vip		
delhisery[.]vip		
dtdcspostb[.]vip		
dtdcspostv[.]vip		
dtdcspostc[.]vip		
hsbc-vnd[.]cc		
hsbc-vns[.]cc		
parisvaihen[.]icu		
parizvaihen[.]icu		
parvaihacn[.]icu		
101[.]33[.]78[.]145	IP	Malicious IP
43[.]130[.]12[.]41		

References:

- www.cyble.com